Foreign Intervention and State Stability

GS II

- Foreign military intervention may weaken or overthrow an existing government, but removing political leadership does not automatically create effective institutions. When administrative structures and security arrangements collapse, the resulting **power vacuum** can make it difficult to restore order and provide essential public services.

- Political instability can intensify when different religious, ethnic or armed groups compete for authority. Without an **inclusive political settlement**, communities may distrust one another and form competing organisations. Such divisions can prolong conflict even after the original government has been removed.

- External powers may establish military bases or support local security forces to maintain influence after intervention. However, **prolonged foreign involvement** can generate resistance among groups that view it as interference. This may strengthen armed movements and complicate efforts to build legitimate national institutions.

- Lasting stability requires institutions capable of maintaining security, resolving political disputes and representing diverse communities. Military operations alone cannot achieve these goals. **Political reconciliation**, accountable governance and locally accepted arrangements are necessary to reduce the risk of renewed conflict.

Foreign intervention may change political leadership, but durable peace depends on legitimate institutions, inclusive governance and political reconciliation rather than military power alone.